

Introductory Session to the Course of Islamic Studies

Saturday, September 20, 2025

Dr. Yasir Mehboob

NUST, Pakistan

Today's Class

- Preliminary Talk
- Why we need Divine Guidance?
- Importance of Islamic Studies for Understanding Islam



Class Conduct

- The importance of Knowledge
- Guidelines
- Attendance
- Assessments



Class Conduct Guidelines

- **Enter with Intention** – Begin each session prepared in mind, materials, and manners.
- **Honor the Learning Space** – Keep it clean, orderly, and free from distractions.
- **Listen to Understand** – Give full attention when others speak; do not interrupt.
- **Speak with Respect** – Choose words that uplift, clarify, and contribute to learning.
- **Engage Wholeheartedly** – Participate actively, ask thoughtful questions, and share insights.
- **Value Time** – Arrive punctually and use every minute productively.
- **Uphold Integrity** – Complete your work honestly; avoid shortcuts that diminish your growth.
- **Support One Another** – Encourage your peers; learning is a shared journey.
- **Few Takes Notes** – to share with others later on. Rest on all focus on the lecture.



Mobile during Class

- China (2025): 79% of university students used their phones during class, often for non-academic purposes. Overuse was linked to reduced engagement and comprehension.
- US (2024): reducing unstructured in-class phone use can improve academic outcomes—especially for students already struggling or from lower socioeconomic backgrounds.
- India (2024): excessive in-class use for non-academic purposes correlated with lower grades and signs of addictive behavior.



Need for Divine Guidance?

- Why do we need divine guidance?
- What is the purpose of humanity? (Activity)



Purpose?

- Is human creation an isolated act or intertwined with a greater Divine Design?



Purpose?

- Who is best suited to declare the purpose of humanity?
- The relation between purpose and freewill
- The purpose is to harness your free will to serve the Divine Will
- Divine Will is that you are Khalifah here, so use whatever is available to you and make progress on individual and collective levels (Khudi).
- Ibadah is the ultimate progress of the soul.
- Harmony and good deeds are the ultimate communal progress.
- Thus we can say: Progress in **Ibadah with Communal Harmony**



Purpose?

- What is needed for completion of the purpose?
- The Divine Guidance is that guide and manual according to each stage and time. It not only guide towards next positive step to elevate, it also guide how to face the challenges and fight the **negative forces** to the elevation.
- Identify the challenges to the purpose of humanity. (Activity)

